TWO ISSUES. ONE CITY COUNCIL.

Columbus Ballot Issues 8 & 9

Both change who elects council members. Only one adds citywide seats.

NOV. 3, 2026 • COLUMBUS, OHIO

START HERE The difference in one glance

ISSUE 8
District representation

Citizen-led proposal

9 DISTRICT SEATS

No citywide council seats

D D D D D D D D D

You vote for your district representative when that seat is up for election.

Current map stays until the regular post-census cycle.

vs.

ISSUE 9
District + citywide

City Council proposal

13 9 DISTRICT + 4 CITYWIDE

Phased in through 2030

D D D D D D D D D + C C C C

You elect your district representative and help elect four citywide representatives across staggered elections.

2027 commission; current map for 2027. New boundaries used in 2029.

D elected by one district | C elected by the whole city | All members are legislative peers.

YOUR BALLOT

Four vote combinations. Three council outcomes.

NO / YES and YES / YES create the same council.

ISSUE 8	ISSUE 9	COUNCIL RESULT	WHAT THIS COMBINATION DOES
NO	NO	**9 members** Voters participate in all 9 over time	**No structural change** Today's system continues.
YES	NO	**9 members** Each elected by one district	**Issue 8 changes who votes** No citywide council seats.
NO	YES	**13 by 2030** 11 beginning in 2028	**Issue 9 sets this structure** District-only voting plus citywide seats.
YES	YES	**Same council as NO / YES** 13 by 2030; 11 beginning in 2028	**No extra structural effect** Issue 9 already includes district-only elections.

Issue 9 phase-in: 9 seats through 2027; 11 beginning in 2028; 13 beginning in 2030.

HOW IT WORKS TODAY

9 districts. 9 members. Every voter participates in all 9 over time.

Members must live in the districts they represent. Across staggered elections, every Columbus voter may vote for all nine seats.

RESIDENCY
One member must live in each district.

ELECTION
Every voter chooses among candidates for all nine seats.

WHY TWO PROPOSALS?

2025 District 7 voters preferred one candidate; the citywide vote elected another.

2026 Our City, Our Say advanced Issue 8. After compromise talks did not produce one amendment, City Council proposed Issue 9.

THE TRADEOFF

D **Neighborhood accountability**
District residents choose their representative.

C **Citywide accountability**
Every voter helps choose members with a citywide constituency.

Neither structure guarantees better government.

OTHER CHANGES **Both:** district members are recalled by their district's voters. **Issue 9:** district candidate petitions drop from 250 to 150 signatures; the maximum population gap between the largest and smallest district rises from 1% to 7.5%; council voting thresholds adjust as seats are added.

The choice is about **who elects whom** - and to whom elected officials are accountable.

NONPARTISAN VOTER INFORMATION This guide does not endorse either proposal.

Sources: Franklin County Board of Elections full text for Issues 8 & 9; City of Columbus council overview; WOSU, Sept. 28, 2026. Accessed Oct. 14, 2026.

READ THE FULL TEXT
Official election information